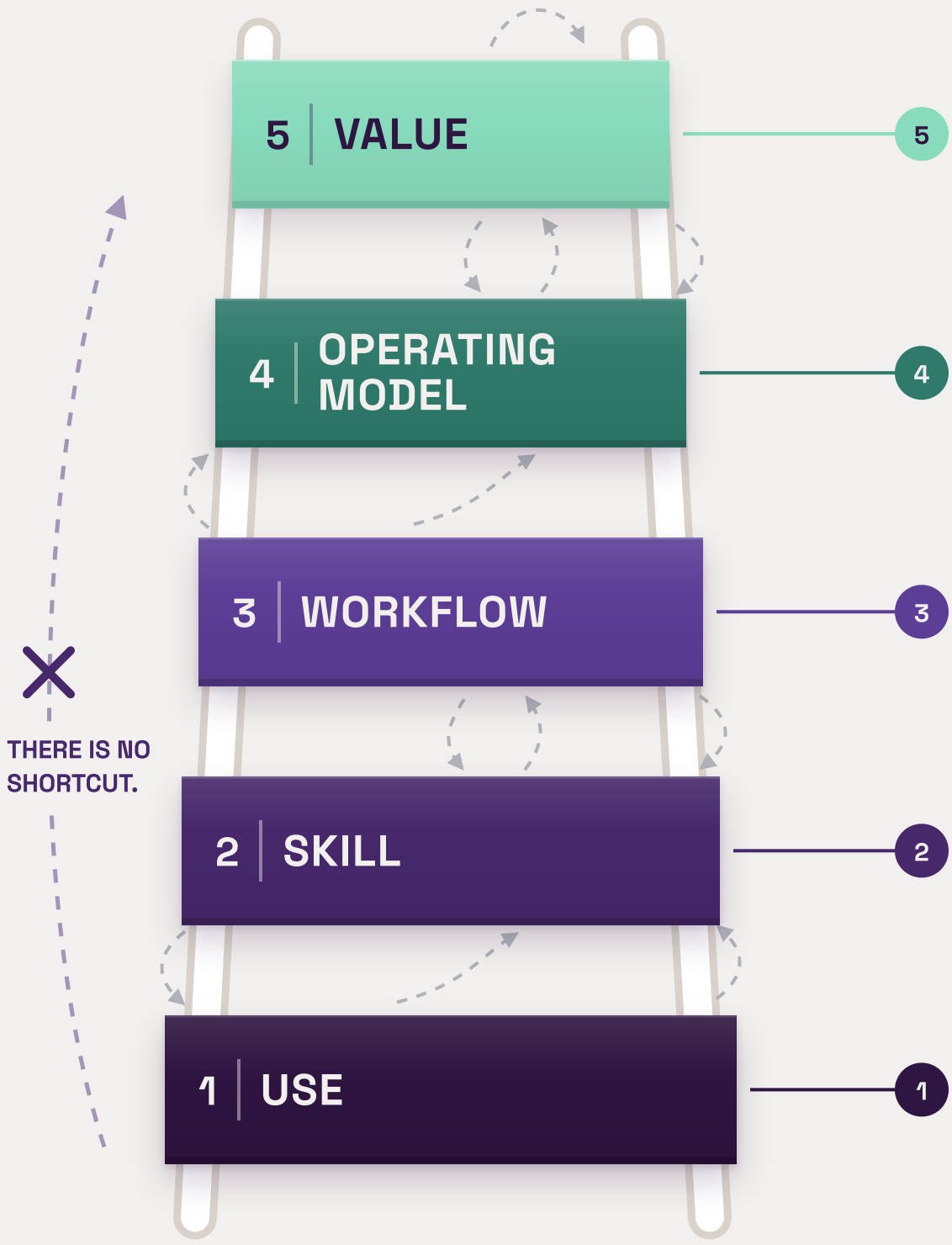
THE AI VALUE LADDER

Most organisations assume that buying AI tools will automatically create value and a good ROI.

It doesn't.



5

VALUE

Results that last beyond the individual.

The change produces measurable results the organisation already cares about.

Does it show up in a metric the organisation already tracks?

4

OPERATING MODEL

The organisation adapts around the new way of working.

Roles, ownership, decision rights and measurement adapt.

If your strongest AI user left tomorrow, would it continue?

3

WORKFLOW

The work itself changes.

AI becomes embedded in the sequence, handovers and steps of recurring work.

Can you name a recurring task that is genuinely done differently?

2

SKILL

People get good results consistently - and know when to question them.

Can they reliably get useful results and recognise when they can't?

1

USE

AI is used in real work.

Licences, access and activity tell you very little about the value created. They are vanity metrics.

Are people actually using AI for meaningful work?

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES

TOOL → PERSON → WORK → ORGANISATION → RESULTS

The tool is only the beginning. Capability has to move into people, the work and the organisation before it shows up in results.

Tools, training and external support can help. But ultimately the organisation has to make the capability its own.